

Strait of Hormuz — Maritime Security Timeline

Alert Window: Today · Generated: 2026-03-13 06:55:10

Situation Brief

The current threat level to transit through the Strait of Hormuz is extremely high, primarily driven by Iran's aggressive military actions, including recent attacks on shipping and energy infrastructure, which have raised immediate concerns over the security of this vital maritime chokepoint. Reports indicate that Iran has targeted vessels, including a US-linked oil tanker, and there are indications that ships are identifying themselves as Chinese to avoid attacks, signaling a significant escalation in hostilities. This environment of heightened risk has led to soaring oil prices, with WTI and Brent crude reaching levels indicative of market anxiety over potential supply disruptions. The situation is compounded by the complete closure of the Strait due to ongoing regional conflicts, which threatens not only energy transit but also broader economic stability. Moving forward, it will be crucial to monitor Iran's military activities and any international responses, as these will significantly impact both maritime security and global oil markets.

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Market Snapshot

As of Mar 12, 2026 16:30 Eastern Daylight Time

WTI
96.04

Brent
97.13

Nat Gas
3.23

VIX
27.27

10Y
4.27

Dollar
99.74

Situation Summary

Events Detected: 11
High Severity: 11
Primary Actor: Iran
Actor Concentration: 45% Iran
Dominant Closure Risk: Full
Market Regime: Structural Tightening

Event Timeline

EVENT CLUSTER — Strait of Hormuz ship attacks: Timeline of Gulf incidents since Feb 28

THREATENED UNKNOWN UNKNOWN CORROBORATED

Mar 13 5:43 · HIGH · immediate · *The Hindu, The Hindu*

The recent escalation of ship attacks in the Strait of Hormuz poses a high-severity, immediate risk to energy transit, threatening the security of vital oil and gas shipments through this critical maritime chokepoint.

2 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 1 of 6

EVENT CLUSTER — Iran's unrelenting attacks on Mideast shipping and energy infrastructure send oil prices soaring

THREATENED IRAN UNKNOWN UNVERIFIED

Mar 13 5:43 · HIGH · immediate · *WWNY*

Iran's ongoing attacks on Middle Eastern shipping and energy infrastructure pose an immediate and high-severity risk of closure to energy transit routes in the Strait of Hormuz, driving oil prices upward.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 2 of 6

EVENT CLUSTER — Ships ID themselves as Chinese around Strait of Hormuz to avoid attacks

THREATENED UNKNOWN UNKNOWN CORROBORATED

Mar 13 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · *Eurasia Review, 1News, وكالة الأنباء العراقية (واع)*

The identification of vessels as Chinese around the Strait of Hormuz to evade attacks signals an immediate and high-severity risk to energy transit, heightening concerns over potential disruptions in this critical maritime corridor.

5 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 3 of 6

EVENT CLUSTER — Did Iran hit US warship Abraham Lincoln? What we know

THREATENED IRAN WARSHIP UNVERIFIED

Mar 13 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · *The Times of India*

The immediate threat of closure to energy transit through the Strait of Hormuz has escalated following reports of Iran potentially targeting the US warship Abraham Lincoln, indicating a high-severity risk to maritime security in the region.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 4 of 6

EVENT CLUSTER — IRGC Strikes US-Linked Oil Tanker in Persian Gulf

THREATENED **IRGC** **TANKER** **UNVERIFIED**

Mar 13 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · *Caspian Post*

The recent IRGC strike on a US-linked oil tanker in the Persian Gulf significantly heightens the risk of closure to energy transit routes, with immediate implications for maritime security and oil supply stability in the region.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 5 of 6

EVENT CLUSTER — The Middle East conflict, which has caused the Strait of Hormuz to be closed, has stopped the safe flow of cargo and other shipments from the region

FULL **UNKNOWN** **CARGO** **UNVERIFIED**

Mar 13 5:00 · HIGH · immediate · *facebook.com*

The ongoing Middle East conflict has resulted in the complete closure of the Strait of Hormuz, posing an immediate and severe threat to the safe transit of cargo shipments and energy flows from the region.

1 source(s) reporting · tightening · cluster 6 of 6

Hormuz Reference

Daily Flow: ~21M bbl crude · ~20% global LNG · 21% world oil supply

Key Exporters: Saudi Arabia, UAE, Kuwait, Iraq, Iran, Qatar (LNG)

Bypass: Saudi East-West Pipeline (~5M bbl/day) · UAE Habshan-Fujairah (~1.5M bbl/day)

Reroute: Cape of Good Hope — +15-20 days, significant cost premium

Geography: Iran controls northern shore · Oman controls southern shore · 21nm at narrowest

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